INCH-POUND

A-A-20203
June 30, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHICKEN, NOODLES, AND VEGETABLES, IN SAUCE, KOSHER AND HALAL, THERMOSTABILIZED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers thermostabilized, kosher certified and halal approved, chicken, noodles, and vegetables in sauce, packed in flexible pouches, suitable for use by the Federal Government and as a component of the Meal, Ready-to-Eat, Individual.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

2.1 Processing. The product shall be prepared in accordance with good commercial practice.

2.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be certified as kosher and approved as halal by recognized rabbinical and Islamic/Muslim organizations/authorities as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order. Proof of their kosher and halal status shall be made available upon request. The chicken, noodles, and vegetables in sauce shall include chicken dices, egg noodles, a poultry sauce, and at least three of the following vegetables: carrots, peas, sliced mushrooms, red pepper dices, cut green beans, onions, and celery.

2.2.1 Noodles. The egg noodles (enriched) shall be fettuccine noodles or heavy soup noodles. The length of the noodles shall be 1.5 $\pm$ 0.5 inches (38 $\pm$ 13 mm). The noodles shall be the type suitable for thermoprocessing.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: SATNC-WRE, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

FSC 8940

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2.2.2 **Vegetables.** The vegetables shall consist of at least three of the following vegetables: carrots, peas, sliced mushrooms, sweet red peppers, cut green beans, onions, and celery.

2.2.3 **Sauce.** The sauce shall contain chicken broth, chicken fat, vegetable oil, and margarine. The product may also contain chicken base, thickeners, herbs, and spices.

2.2.4 **Chicken.** Chicken shall be prepared from chilled or frozen ready-to-cook fowl (mature female chicken) which has been processed and certified in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. Raw (uncooked) bone-in or boneless chicken received in the chilled state shall not have been previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F (4.4°C) for a period of time not to exceed 6 days following initial chilling and prior to preparation and further processing. Raw (uncooked) bone-in or boneless chicken received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 0°F (-17.8°C) for a period of time not to exceed 120 days following initial freezing and prior to preparation and further processing. Chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Poultry Products Grading Certificate to certify class and condition of the product and either the initial chilling date or initial freezing (in-storage) date.

2.2.4.1 **Individually quick frozen (IQF) chicken dices.** The IQF chicken dices shall have been prepared from chicken meeting the requirements of paragraph 2.2.4 above. The chicken shall be made boneless and skinless. The wing tips, giblets, neck, feet, and viscera shall be excluded. The boned meat shall be free of pin feathers, skin, blood clots, bruises, blemishes, ligaments, tendons, coarse connective tissue, cartilage, and bone greater than 0.3 inch (8 mm) in any dimension. The boneless meat shall be in natural proportions as removed from the whole fowl carcass. The chicken shall be cooked either before or after deboning by any commercially acceptable cook method in accordance with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The cooked chicken meat shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings not less than 5/8 by 5/8 inch (15 mm) dimensions and not more than 3/4 by 3/4 inch (19 mm) dimensions ($\pm$ 1/16 inch [2 mm] in each dimension). The cooked chicken dices shall be individually quick frozen by an in-line individual quick freezing process to prevent dices from sticking together after they are packaged. Immediately after the IQF process, the frozen chicken dices shall be packaged and sealed in USDA approved food packaging material. The packaged dices must be placed into a freezer and the internal temperature lowered to 0°F (-17.8°C) or lower within 24 hours from the time the individual frozen dices were packaged. The package of cooked, individually frozen dices shall have been held at 0°F (-17.8°C) or below for a period not to exceed 120 days. Compliance with the requirements and processing of boneless skinless meat, meat in natural proportion, cooking, cooling, dice size requirements, individual quick freezing, and other times and temperatures, as described in this section, will be evidenced by a USDA certificate.

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2.3 Finished product. The finished product shall be a uniform mixture of chicken, noodles, and vegetables in a pleasing, poultry flavored sauce. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

2.3.1 Appearance. The sauce shall have a pale gold or light tan color and may contain visible flecks of herbs and spices. The chicken dices, egg noodles, and vegetables shall be intact pieces with a characteristic color. There shall be no foreign color to the product.

2.3.2 Odor and flavor. The chicken dices shall have a mild poultry flavor and odor with no evidence of rancidity. The sauce shall have a pleasing flavor of poultry and mild spices. The egg noodles and vegetables shall have a characteristic odor and flavor with no evidence of oxidation. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, or stale.

2.3.3 Texture. The chicken dices shall be moist and tender, not dry, rubbery, or mushy. The texture of the sauce shall be moderately thick and not excessively thin, thick, or pasty. The texture of the egg noodles shall be soft, not mushy, hard, or pasty. The vegetables shall be firm, not hard, fibrous, mushy, or tough.

2.3.4 Foreign material. There shall be no bone, feathers, or feather parts. Total weight of skin, cartilage, coarse connective tissue, sections of tendons or ligaments, and discolored meat, collectively in a pouch, shall not be more than 0.20 ounce (5.7 g). There shall be no evidence of rodents and no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, or metal.

2.3.5 Net and drained weight. The net weight of an individual pouch shall be not less than 7.5 ounces (212.6 g). No individual pouch shall contain less than 2.0 ounces (56.7 g) drained weight of chicken dices, 1.5 ounces (42.5 g) drained weight of vegetables and not less than 2.0 ounces (56.7 g) drained weight of egg noodles.

2.3.6 Fat and salt content. The salt content of an individual pouch shall be not less than 0.5 percent or greater than 1.5 percent. The fat content of an individual pouch shall be not more than 5.0 percent.

2.4 Pouch filling and sealing. Each pouch shall be filled with 8 ounces (226.8 g) of product so as to conform to the finished product and analytical requirements.

2.5 Thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed pouch shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing and shall be thermoprocessed by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

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2.6 Analytical requirements. Eight filled, sealed, and thermoprocessed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of lot size and individually tested for fat and salt content. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the finished product requirements, as indicated by USDA test results, shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Analyses shall be made in accordance with the following methods of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC:

Test	Method
Fat	925.12
Salt	935.47

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

3.1 The delivered chicken, noodles, and vegetables in sauce shall conform with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. Delivered chicken, noodles, and vegetables in sauce shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's certification. By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and at any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Quality assurance. When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity. The chicken, noodles, and vegetables in sauce shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The chicken, noodles, and vegetables in sauce shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Vendors are permitted to place the kosher and halal certification symbol(s) and/or markings on individual packages and shipping containers. The symbols attest to compliance with applicable dietary (kosher and halal) laws. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

6. FOR DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE PROCUREMENTS

6.1 The following tests and examinations are applicable to Department of Defense procurements of Operational Rations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

6.2 First article. When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires a first article, it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

6.3 Packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The chicken, noodles, and vegetables in sauce shall be filled and sealed into a heat sealable flexible pouch, thermoprocessed, unit packed into paperboard cartons, and packed for shipment in accordance with class 1 of MIL-P-44073, Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches. Labeling of pouches, marking of paperboard cartons and marking of shipping containers shall also be in accordance with MIL-P-44073. Inspection of filled and sealed pouches, paperboard cartons and shipping containers shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

6.4 Net weight examination. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty pouch. Any individual net weight of less than 7.5 ounces (212.6 g) shall be classified as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3, and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce (3 g). In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 8.0 ounces (226.8 g).

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6.5 Product and drained weight examination.

6.5.1 Double sampling plan for product examination. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in Table I utilizing the double sampling plans indicated in MIL-STD-105. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature 65 to 75°F (18 to 24°C) after completion of the thermostabilization operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180 to 190°F (83 to 87°C) for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/ 3/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Not a uniform mixture of chicken, egg noodles, vegetables, and sauce.
102	Color and content of sauce not as specified.
103	Odor and flavor of chicken, egg noodles, vegetables, or sauce not as specified.
104	Egg noodles not a characteristic, fettuccine or heavy soup noodle shape.
105	Texture of chicken dices dry, rubbery, or mushy.
106	Texture of egg noodles is mushy or hard.
107	Texture of vegetables is hard, fibrous, mushy, or tough.
108	Sauce consistency is excessively thin, thick, or pasty.
109	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

1/ Any product not kosher certified and halal approved shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ The presence of any foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale),

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or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

3/ Product not equal to or better than the approved first article sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

6.5.2 Double sampling plan for drained weight examination. The finished product shall be examined for the drained weight defects listed in Table II utilizing the double sampling plans indicated in MIL-STD-105. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature 65 to 75°F (18 to 24°C) after completion of the thermostabilization operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180 to 190°F (83 to 87°C) water for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

TABLE II. Drained weight defects 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Drained weight of chicken dices less than 2.0 ounces (56.7 g).
102	Drained weight of vegetables less than 1.5 ounces (42.5 g).
103	Drained weight of egg noodles less than 2.0 ounces (56.7 g).

1/ To determine the drained weight, the pouch contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the pouch's volume of 180 to 190°F (83 to 87°C) water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated without breaking the pasta or vegetables. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard No. 7 sieve (2.80 mm) in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the pasta or vegetables. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45°angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce (3 g).

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7. NOTES

7.1 Sources of documents.

7.1.1 Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC may be obtained from:

AOAC International
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

Information concerning kosher certification and halal approval of this product may be obtained from:

Commander
U.S. Army Natick Research,
Development, and Engineering Center
ATTN: SATNC-WRD
Natick, MA 01760-5018

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7.1.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations are contained in 9 CFR Parts 200 to end. The Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act can be found in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. These documents may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Copies of Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches (MIL-P-44073) and Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes (MIL-STD-105) are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

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Military activities should submit request for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
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Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project 8940-0776

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